

Pressure Cooker Shrimp Biryani

Recipe from Chandra Ram

Adapted by Melissa Clark

Time 30 minutes

Rating ★★☆☆☆ (1011)



Andrew Scrivani for The New York Times

The key to cooking shrimp biryani in an electric pressure cooker is to buy jumbo shrimp, which won't overcook in the amount of time it takes to cook the rice. This version, from Chandra Ram's "The Complete Indian Instant Pot Cookbook," is bright with ginger root, fresh curry leaves and plenty of lime juice. Kashmiri chile is a very mild red chile powder that can be found in Indian markets, but if you can't get it, substitute three parts sweet paprika and one part cayenne. And if you can't get the fresh curry leaves, simply leave them out. The dish won't be quite as fragrant, but will still be delicious. —**Melissa Clark**

INGREDIENTS

Yield: 6 servings

- 2 cups basmati rice
- 2 teaspoons vegetable oil
- 1 onion, chopped
- 1 Serrano chile, minced
- 2 tablespoons minced fresh ginger
- 1 tablespoon minced garlic
- 2 teaspoons kosher salt
- 1 teaspoon Kashmiri chile powder
- 1 teaspoon ground turmeric

PREPARATION

Step 1

Place the rice in a bowl and cover with 2 cups water. Let stand for 20 minutes, then drain and rinse.

Step 2

Heat oil in the pot of an electric pressure cooker with the sauté function set on high, until oil is shimmering. Add onion; cook for about 4 minutes, until softened. Stir in Serrano chile, ginger, garlic, salt, chile powder, turmeric, paprika and curry leaves; cook for about 1 minute, until fragrant.

Step 3

Stir in boiling water; using a wooden spoon, stir, scraping

1 teaspoon smoked paprika
10 fresh curry leaves, torn
into pieces
1½ cups boiling water
1½ pounds jumbo shrimp
(16 to 20 or fewer per pound,
see note), peeled and
deveined
1 (15-ounce) can diced
tomatoes, with juice
2 teaspoons freshly squeezed
lime juice, plus more wedges
for serving
½ cup chopped fresh cilantro

up any browned bits on the bottom of the pot. Stir in
soaked rice, shrimp and tomatoes (with juice).

Step 4

Secure the lid and cook on high pressure for 3 minutes.
Quick-release the pressure, stir lime juice into the rice,
then cover the pressure cooker with a kitchen towel and
let it sit for 5 minutes.

Step 5

Give rice a stir, then taste and add more salt, if needed.
Transfer to a platter, garnish with cilantro and serve with
lime wedges on the side.

TIP

*Make sure to use jumbo shrimp or larger for this recipe.
Look for “16/20” or “U/15” on the package; this indicates
how many shrimp there are per pound.*

Private Notes

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